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AI



Google Discover adds AI summaries, threatening publishers with further traffic declines

As publishers fret about [decreased traffic from Google](#), the search giant has begun rolling out AI summaries in Discover, the main news feed inside Google's search app on iOS and Android. Now, instead of seeing a headline from a major publication, users will see multiple news publishers' logos in the top-left corner, followed by an AI-generated summary that cites those sources.

The app warns that these summaries are generated with AI, "which can make mistakes."

IMAGE CREDITS: GOOGLE

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Meta plans to spend hundreds of billions on AI data centers, some built in tents, to accelerate its superintelligence push. The first center, Prometheus, will launch in 2026. Meta is also considering a shift to closed-source AI models.

Generated with AI, which can make mistakes



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The feature is not yet appearing for all news stories within the Google app. In tests, TechCrunch was able to view the AI summaries firsthand across both iOS and Android apps in the U.S.

Reached for comment, a Google spokesperson confirmed this is not a test, but actually a U.S. launch. The feature will appear on iOS and Android in the U.S., with a focus on trending lifestyle topics like sports and entertainment. Google also noted the feature will make it easier for people to decide what pages they want to visit.

In addition to the summaries, Google has been trying out other ways to present the news displayed

■ Lina Khan points to Figma IPO as vindication of M&A scrutiny

■ Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines

In Discover. Though not flagged as powered by AI, [some stories will include a set of bullet points](#) below the headline or will be grouped with similar news.

For instance, a story about President Trump's Ukraine deal also included links to other stories about Trump's latest actions. Meanwhile, a story from The Washington Post about ICE was followed by bullet points that summarized the story's content.



IMAGE CREDITS:GOOGLE

The update to the search app comes as a number of publishers have been experimenting with AI on their own sites, including [The Wall Street Journal](#), [Yahoo](#), [Bloomberg](#), [USA Today](#), and others. Startups, too,

have gotten in on the action, as with [Particle, a news reader](#) that uses AI to not only summarize stories but also allow users to see different sides or ask follow-up questions to better understand the topic covered.



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Despite these trials, there's significant [concern in the publishing industry](#) about how the shift to AI is impacting website traffic and referrals. With features like Google's AI Overviews and AI Mode, users no longer have to visit a website directly to get answers to their search queries — it can be summarized for them automatically or shared in a chatbot-style interface. Outside of Google, this same trend is seen across other AI apps, like ChatGPT or Perplexity.

Recently, Google tried to appease publishers with [the launch of Offerwall](#), a feature that allows publishers to generate revenue beyond the more traffic-dependent options, like ads. With Offerwall, publishers who use Google Ad Manager can try out different methods to provide access to their

content, like micropayments or having users take surveys, sign up for newsletters, watch ads, and more.

But for many publishers, these tools are coming too late, as traffic is already in a steep decline.

A story by [The Economist](#) this week noted that worldwide search traffic fell by 15% year-over-year as of June, citing data from market intelligence company [Similarweb](#).

Earlier data from the firm [also found that](#) the number of news searches on the web that result in no click-throughs to news websites had grown from 56% in May 2024, when AI Overviews launched, to nearly 69% as of May 2025. Organic traffic also declined, dropping from over 2.3 billion visits at its peak in mid-2024 to fewer than 1.7 billion, it noted.

Amid this shift, Google Discover still remained a source for clicks, even as traffic from Google Search declined. But that may no longer be the case if the AI summaries roll out more broadly within the Google app.

Updated after publication with Google's comment confirming it's a U.S. launch.

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Consumer News Editor | [X](#) [🦋](#) [m](#) [in](#)

Sarah has worked as a reporter for TechCrunch since August 2011. She joined the company after having...

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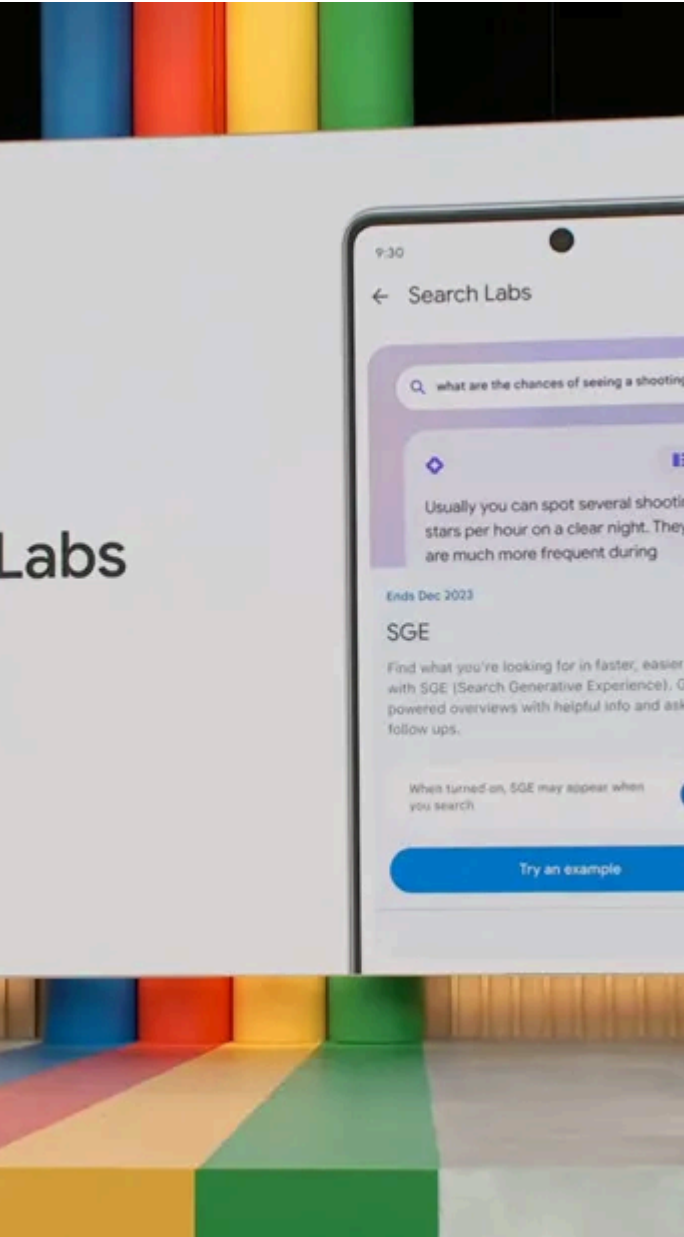


IMAGE CREDITS: GOOGLE

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Facebook, X, LinkedIn, Reddit, Email, Link

Google’s AI search experience adds AI-powered summaries, definitions and coding improvements

Sarah Perez — 9:00 AM PDT · August 15, 2023

Google today is rolling out a few new updates to its nearly three-month-old [Search Generative Experience \(SGE\)](#), the company’s AI-powered conversational mode in Search, with a goal of helping users better learn and make sense of the information they discover on the web. The features include tools to see definitions of unfamiliar terms,

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those that help to improve your understanding and coding information across languages, and an interesting feature that lets you tap into the AI power of SGE while you’re browsing.

The company [explains](#) that these improvements aim to help people better understand complicated concepts or complex topics, boost their coding skills and more.

One of the new features will let you hover over certain words to preview their definitions and see related images or diagrams related to the topic, which you can then tap on to learn more. This feature will become available across Google’s AI-generated responses to topics or questions related to certain subjects, like STEM, economics, history and others, where you may encounter terms you don’t understand or concepts you want to dive deeper into for a better understanding.

Bing Chat also [offers a feature similar](#) to this that lets you highlight the text in question on a page and then select Bing from the options menu to engage in a conversation where you can learn more about the topic.

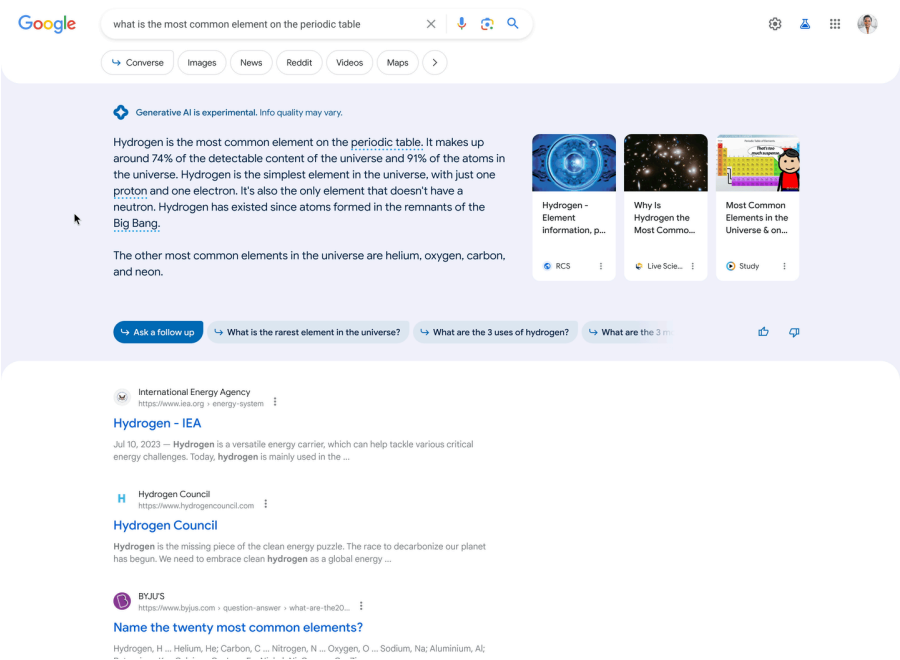
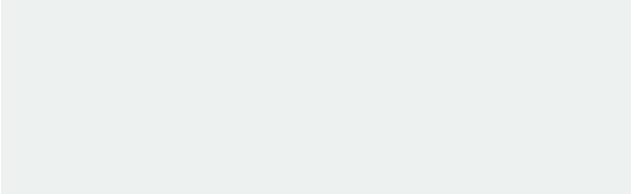


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Another new feature will help those using SGE for programming assistance. The new capabilities will make it easier to understand and debug the generated code, says Google.

Currently, SGE provides AI-generated overviews that help with tasks related to programming languages and tools, allowing users to find answers to their how-to questions or see generated code snippets. The new update will now color-code segments of code with syntax highlights, making it easier to identify different elements like keywords, comments and strings.

SGE while browsing may be the most interesting new addition, but for now it's only an early experiment in Search Labs, available on the Google app for Android and iOS and later, Chrome on the desktop.

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IMAGE CREDITS: GOOGLE

For instance, on some web pages, you can tap to see an AI-generated list of the key points an article covers with links that take you directly to the part you were looking for.

The page will also include an “Explore on page” option where you can see the questions an article answers and then jump to the relevant section.

The feature is reminiscent of the existing [content highlighting search feature](#) that will jump you to relevant text when you search for specific terms and a matching result is found. However, this time it’s powered by AI.

Rival [Bing Chat also already offers a similar feature](#) that lets you tap the Bing Chat icon while reading an article or document online and ask Chat to summarize the content for you — so this, again, is a little bit of catch-up on Google’s part.

IMAGE CREDITS: GOOGLE

Google notes this feature will not provide AI summaries for paywalled articles, and publishers can choose to block the feature by designating their content as paywalled in the [Help Center](#).

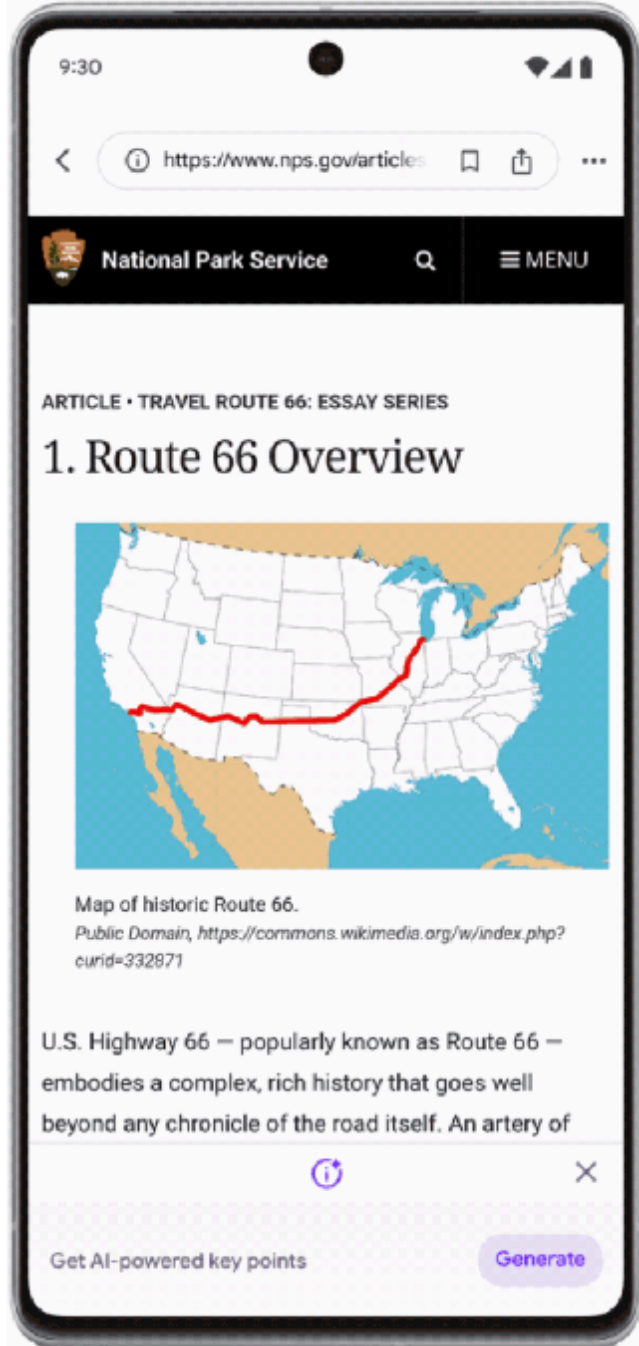


IMAGE CREDITS: GOOGLE

Google and Bing are not the only ones thinking about how AI can be used to summarize text. News reading app Artifact, from Instagram's founders, [also began offering an AI summary feature](#) as of its April 2023 update.

SGE while browsing is available as a stand-alone experiment in Search Labs, and will automatically roll out to those who have already opted into SGE.

The features follow other new additions to SGE, including a feature launched earlier this month that [shows videos and images](#) related to users' search queries.

Search Labs is available through the Google app on Android and iOS and Chrome on the desktop.

[Google's generative search feature now shows related videos and images](#)

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Google Gemini can now do more in-depth research

Google is upgrading [Gemini](#), its chatbot platform, with the ability to “reason” through a research problem and compile a comprehensive report.

The updated Gemini offers a feature called “Deep Research” that Google says uses “advanced reasoning” and “long context capabilities” to generate research briefs. The briefs are presented in the Gemini apps and can be exported to Google Docs for additional editing.

For now, Deep Research is exclusive to Gemini Advanced, a more sophisticated version of Gemini that’s gated behind the [Google One AI Premium Plan](#), priced at \$20 a month.

IMAGE CREDITS:

RAFAEL HENRIQUE/SOPA IMAGES/LIGHTROCKET /
GETTY IMAGES

Diving deep

Google says that Deep Research can analyze information relevant to a query from across the web on a user’s behalf, acting as a sort of research assistant. The results are organized into summaries within the brief and paired with links to the original source material.

Here’s how it works:

- 01 A user writes a question.
- 02 Deep Research creates a “multi-step research plan” for the user to either revise or approve.

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Google takes on ChatGPT’s Study Mode with new ‘Guided Learning’ tool in Gemini

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03 Once the user approves, Deep Research refines its analysis over the course of a few minutes — searching, saving potentially interesting pieces of information, and then starting a new search based on what it’s learned.

04 The process repeats multiple times, and once it’s finished, Deep Research generates a report of the key findings.

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Deep Research is available only in English on desktop and the mobile web to start. Users can access it by selecting the “[Gemini 1.5 Pro](#) with Deep Research” option in the model’s drop-down menu. Google says it’ll come to the Gemini mobile apps in early 2025.

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The new Deep Research feature from Google feels like one of the most appropriately “Google-y” uses of AI to date, and is quite impressive.

I've had access for a bit and it does very good initial reports on almost any topic. The paywalls around academic sources puts some limits.

pic.twitter.com/dwSqr6aKGZ

— Ethan Mollick (@emollick) [December 11, 2024](#)

“We’ve built a new agentic system that uses Google’s expertise of finding relevant information on the web to direct Gemini’s browsing and research,” David Citron, product director for the Gemini apps, wrote in a blog post provided to TechCrunch. “Deep Research saves you hours of time.”

But the feature raises all sorts of thorny ethical questions.

Potential harms

Setting aside the fact that all AI [make mistakes](#) and [hallucinate](#) (anyone remember [glue pizza?](#)), technology like Deep Research could have serious consequences for education.

In a recent [op-ed](#) in The New York Times, Jessica Grose wrote about how students are increasingly relying on generative AI to outsource brainstorming and writing. These students, she said, risk losing the ability to think critically and overcome their frustration with tasks that can’t be completed easily.

At least one [study](#) has linked heavy usage of ChatGPT among students to higher levels of procrastination, memory loss, and lower grade point averages.

Deep Research also threatens to harm — in the monetary sense, that is — the publishers from which it sources its information. By scraping info from websites and compiling it into briefs, Deep

Research could deprive these sites of valuable ad revenue.

The impact of [AI Overviews](#), the AI-generated summaries Google supplies for certain Google Search queries, on publishers may be indicative of what's to come, should Deep Research take off.

[According](#) to one source, publishers have seen a 5% to 10% decrease in traffic from search since AI Overviews launched early this year. On the revenue side, an expert cited by The New York Post [estimated](#) that AI-generated overviews could lead to more than \$2 billion in losses for publishers.

Google often says it works closely with publisher partners, respects paywalls, and allows websites to block its AI scraping at the domain level. But outlets are often faced with a [dilemma](#): Allow scraping or lose visibility in Google Search ([at least for now](#)).

Google is claiming Deep Research could “connect users to relevant websites they might not have found otherwise so they can dive deeper to learn more.” We’ll have to see whether the feature delivers on that discoverability promise or whether it diverts views away from the broader web.

Gemini 2.0 Flash

Deep Research isn't the only new capability coming to Gemini.

Starting today, both free and paying Gemini users will get access to [Gemini 2.0 Flash](#), Google's newest flagship AI model. To be precise, it's an experimental version of 2.0 Flash optimized for chat — the full version will arrive in January.

Google says 2.0 Flash, which can be selected from the Gemini model drop-down on desktop and the mobile web (but not the mobile apps yet), should

deliver better performance across a number of tasks — and faster responses.

Still, the company cautions some Gemini features “won’t be compatible with [the] model in its experimental state.” It didn’t say which features, exactly.

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Kyle Wiggers was TechCrunch’s AI Editor until June 2025. His writing has appeared in VentureBeat and Digital Trend...

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